

ENTRY PRINCIPLE

Earn the right to standardize.

The objective is not to import an operating template. It is to establish enough shared truth that Automata can preserve what clients value, remove avoidable friction, and scale evidence-backed patterns.

Days 0-30 - Establish the truth

- Listen with founders/executives, sales, delivery, technical teams, client success, finance, operations, and representative clients.
- Build a portfolio inventory linking client promise, workflow, automation, owner, run state, exception history, adoption, value evidence, support burden, and reuse potential.
- Map the critical handoffs and identify where context, authority, or acceptance evidence is lost.
- Review the revenue model, pricing, backlog, capacity, utilization, platform/model costs, delivery cycle, support load, cash mechanics, and financial reporting definitions.
- Document immediate client, delivery, legal, security, quality, workforce, and business-continuity risks.

Outputs

- Company listening map
- Portfolio and operating baseline
- Decision-rights inventory
- Financial and capacity question set
- Immediate-risk register

Do not do yet

- Reorganize on anecdote
- Declare arbitrary targets
- Standardize legitimate client differentiation
- Add dashboards before agreeing on definitions
- Automate a broken handoff

30-DAY LEADERSHIP REVIEW

Question	Decision	Evidence
Where is executive attention being consumed repeatedly?	Assign owner, install mechanism, or retain as executive judgment.	Decision log, recurrence, client consequence, risk.
Where is growth creating support debt?	Contain, reprice, redesign, standardize, or stop.	Support load, exception pattern, economics, client outcome.
Which current strengths must not be damaged?	Protect the relationship, speed, craft, or differentiated capability.	Client and team testimony, renewal/usage evidence, strategic value.

Days 31-60 - Clarify the operating contract

- Define a service architecture that distinguishes discovery, custom build, reusable component, managed run/support, advisory, and productized offerings where appropriate.
- Clarify decision rights for scope, design, model/tool choice, human authority, acceptance, incident response, client communication, change requests, and stop/hold decisions.
- Agree on the minimum evidence required before work begins, is accepted, enters recurring operation, expands, or is reused.
- Define a small balanced scorecard spanning client value, run health, adoption, economics, and learning.
- Identify legitimate variation versus repeated failure modes and avoidable customization.

Days 61-90 - Run the cadence

- Launch the Automation Yield Review: a weekly decision forum connecting pipeline, capacity, delivery, recurring run health, client outcomes, financial drivers, incidents, and reusable learning.
- Introduce a clear portfolio state for commit, watch, hold, recover, productize, or stop - with owner and next evidence.
- Install a blameless incident-learning mechanism that links failure mode, human authority, recovery, client communication, recurrence risk, and operating-rule change.
- Connect workforce planning and development to the service model, capability gaps, expected demand, and leadership load.
- Move recurring executive decisions into explicit mechanisms without stripping teams of judgment.

OPERATING-CADENCE ARCHITECTURE

Cadence	Purpose	Primary decisions
Weekly Automation Yield Review	Portfolio truth and cross-functional operating decisions	Capacity, escalation, client risk, hold/stop, reuse, owner
Delivery and run-health huddle	Near-term coordination and exceptions	Recovery, handoff, support, acceptance evidence
Monthly business review	Economics, demand, client outcomes, workforce, risks	Investment, pricing/service changes, hiring, priorities
Quarterly operating plan	Strategic allocation and capability building	Portfolio bets, productization, partnerships, systems, talent

Days 91-120 - Scale the patterns

- Select repeated, evidence-backed work for reusable components, playbooks, training, managed services, or productization.
- Align team structure, leadership roles, hiring, development, and external partners to the service architecture and demand model.
- Set quarterly operating priorities and guardrails for client outcomes, capacity, margin drivers, reliability, adoption, reuse, and risk.
- Close or redesign the mechanisms that create activity without decision value.
- Present the operating roadmap with explicit assumptions, unresolved questions, owners, and proof points.

120-DAY OUTCOMES

Shared truth Leadership and teams use common definitions for the portfolio, performance, risk, economics, and ownership.	Clear authority Decisions are made at the right level, with human judgment and escalation explicit.
Evidence-based cadence Reviews produce decisions, owners, and learning rather than status narration.	Capacity visibility Demand, staffing, delivery load, support burden, and critical skills can be discussed together.
Pattern portfolio Repeated work has a path to reuse or productization; exceptions have a containment path.	Operating roadmap The next two quarters are framed as measurable bets with assumptions and proof points.

SUCCESS MEASURES FOR THE ENTRY PLAN

Dimension	Evidence of progress
Decision quality	Fewer recurring unresolved decisions; clearer owner and evidence requirements.
Delivery	Handoffs, acceptance, change, and escalation become visible and repeatable.
Client	Value claims and adoption evidence are clearer; risks are communicated earlier.
Economics	Leadership can connect service mix, capacity, support, reuse, and margin drivers.
Learning	Recurring failures produce rule changes; repeated success produces reusable assets.
Organization	Roles, decision rights, development, and hiring align with the chosen service model.

Operating posture: protect what is creating trust and momentum; change what is preventing the company from learning and scaling.